

# **LIFE SPRING DOMINION CHURCH INTERNATIONAL CONSTITUTION AND RULES**

**Revised Edition**

**5th November 2025**

**P.O. Box 406-40222, Oyugis, Kenya**

**Headquarters: Mount Zion the New Jerusalem (Nyaduma Village), Oyugis**

## **PREAMBLE**

Whereas it is the express purpose of Almighty God to call out a people for Himself who shall constitute the Body of Christ, built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Jesus Christ as the chief cornerstone;

And whereas the members of this body are enjoined by Scripture to assemble for worship, prayer, fellowship, the ministry of the Word, and the exercise of spiritual gifts in an orderly manner;

Acknowledging the supremacy of Almighty God of all creation, the infallible authority of the Holy Bible as the final rule of faith and conduct (2 Timothy 3:16-17), the Constitution of the Republic of Kenya 2010 as the supreme law of the land, and all other applicable laws, statutes, regulations, directives, and policies of the Government of the Republic of Kenya (including but not limited to the Societies Act Cap 108, the Charities Act, the Education Act, the Data Protection Act 2019, and all relevant subsidiary legislation);

And recognizing the need for orderly governance consistent with biblical revelation and in full compliance with the Constitution of Kenya and all government laws;

We, the members of Life Spring Dominion Church International, in order to preserve unity, promote holiness, advance the Gospel, disciple believers, and transform nations through the rivers of living water, do hereby adopt this Constitution, together with its Code of Conduct and Rules, trusting in the guidance of the Holy Spirit.

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## **ARTICLE 1: NAME, HEADQUARTERS AND REGISTERED OFFICE**

- 1.1. The name of the society shall be LIFE SPRING DOMINION CHURCH INTERNATIONAL (hereinafter referred to as “LSDCI” or “the Church”).
- 1.2. The registered headquarters shall be located at Mount Zion the New Jerusalem (Nyaduma Village), Oyugis, Kenya.
- 1.3. The registered postal address shall be P.O. Box 406-40222, Oyugis, Kenya.

## **ARTICLE 2: LOGO**

The official logo of the Church shall be:

LIFE SPRING DOMINION CHURCH INTERNATIONAL



LIFE SPRING DOMINION CHURCH INTERNATIONAL

### **ARTICLE 2.1: OFFICIAL INSIGNIA AND FLAG (Bishop's Standard)**

**Section 1: The Official Flag** of the Church shall be a rectangular white fabric field, bordered on the upper, lower, and fly edges with a golden-yellow looped fringe. The banner is mounted on the hoist side to a silver-colored metallic staff, surmounted by a gold-colored cylindrical or spherical finial. Centered upon the white field shall be the official seal of the Church.

**Section 2: The Official Seal and Emblem Specifications** The seal depicted on the official banner consists of a circular emblem, detailed as follows:

- **The Circumference:** The outer perimeter features a golden border, inside of which the words "LIFE SPRING DOMINION CHURCH INTERNATIONAL" are inscribed in blue, uppercase typography, arching along the upper hemisphere.

- **The Core Imagery:** Centered within the circle is a stylized depiction of the global map in shades of blue and white, representing the worldwide scope of the ministry.
- **The Sovereign Symbols:** Superimposed over the globe is a radiant golden cross, emitting light streams. At the intersection of the cross sits a white dove facing left, symbolizing the Holy Spirit. Two golden-hilted ceremonial swords point downward and inward from the lower flanks of the globe.
- **The Foundation:** The entire central graphic rests upon an open book, symbolizing the Holy Scriptures (The Bible).
- **The Scriptural Anchor:** Inscribed horizontally within the lower curve of the circular border, directly beneath the open book, is the scriptural citation "**JOHN 7:38**" in bold, blue lettering.



### Section 3: The Episcopal Vehicular Flag

- **A. Mandate and Authorization:** The motor vehicle actively transporting is Eminence the Bishop for official ministry, pastoral visitations, or state functions is authorized and mandated to fly the designated Episcopal Car Flag.
- **B. Protocol and Restrictions:**
  - **Active Transport Only:** The vehicular flag shall only be uncovered or displayed when the Presiding Bishop is physically present inside the vehicle or arriving at an official venue.
  - **Covering the Flag:** When the vehicle is being driven without the Bishop present (e.g., by staff running errands or during transit prior to pickup), the flag must be removed or covered with a protective sleeve to maintain the integrity and dignity of the symbol.

## **ARTICLE 3: VISION, MISSION AND CORE VALUES**

### **3.1 Corporate Vision (John 7:38)**

To raise a global generation of Spirit-filled believers overflowing with the life of Christ - transforming nations through the rivers of living waters that flow within them, bringing healing, revival and dominion to every sphere of life.

### **3.2 Mission Statement (John 14:6)**

To lead people into a deep, life-giving relationship with Jesus Christ, nurturing them through the true Word and the Spirit until they become fountains of divine life — impacting their communities, discipling nations and manifesting God's Kingdom, power and glory in every place.

### **3.3 Core Values**

**Faith in God:** We live by unwavering faith in the Word and promises of God (James 1:5-6).

**The Word and the Spirit:** We are guided and empowered by the living Word and the Holy Spirit who produce rivers of life within us.

**Holiness and Integrity:** We Walk in purity of heart, truth and righteousness as vessels of honour in God's Kingdom.

**Love and Compassion:** We demonstrate the love of Christ through service, care and compassion to all people.

**Excellence and Stewardship:** We serve God and humanity with diligence, creativity and excellence in all we do.

**Discipleship and Dominion:** We raise Kingdom leaders who influence and transform societies under the Lordship of Christ.

**Revival and Impact:** We carry the living water of the Spirit to revive souls, heal nations and expand God's Kingdom on earth (Revelation 1:10).

## **ARTICLE 4: STATEMENT OF FAITH**

The Church fully subscribes to the Holy Bible (39 books of the Old Testament and 27 books of the New Testament) as the inspired, infallible and final authority in all matters of faith and conduct (2 Timothy 3:16-17; Revelation 22:18-19).

The Church affirms the following fundamental beliefs:

(All original doctrinal points retained verbatim with corrected spelling/grammar for clarity — Godhead, virgin birth, sin, repentance, restitution, justification, water baptism (one

immersion), Lord's Supper, sanctification, Holy Ghost baptism with tongues as initial evidence, divine healing, evangelism, monogamous marriage, rapture (pre-tribe), resurrection, tribulation, second coming, millennium, great white throne judgment, new heaven/earth, hell fire.)

#### **ARTICLE 4.1: OBJECTIVES**

Relevant Scripture: Matthew 28:19-20; Acts 1:8 objectives of the Church are:

- 4.11 To preach and spread the Gospel of Jesus Christ worldwide.
- 4.1.2 To conduct crusades, seminars, trainings, workshops and evangelism locally and internationally.
- 4.1.3 To build, buy, hire, maintain and operate church buildings, social halls and other facilities.
- 4.1.4 To baptize believers, conduct weddings, burials, conferences and community social work.
- 4.1.5 To assist the needy, including orphans, widows, the aged and street children.
- 4.1.6 To plant churches, ordain and license pastors.
- 4.1.7 To facilitate community development and moral health welfare.
- 4.1.8 To form branches nationally and internationally.
- 4.1.9 To establish and sponsor learning institutions from early childhood to university level and a theological college.
- 4.1.10 To provide affiliation to like-minded churches and ministries.
- 4.1.11 To partner with government and public schools for spiritual, moral and administrative guidance.
- 4.1.12 To raise and fly the white flag as a symbolic declaration of the Gospel of peace worldwide.
- 4.1.13 To cooperate and partner with local and international organizations for the advancement of the Gospel and holistic community transformation.
- 4.1.14 To do all other lawful things incidental or conducive to the above objectives.
- 4.1.15 The Church is non-political and non-profit-making.

## **5.0 ARTICLES MARRIAGE.**

Marriage, under the laws of Kenya, is defined as the voluntary union of a man and a woman, whether in monogamous or polygamous form, registered in accordance with the Marriage Act No. 4 of 2014, with parties to a marriage holding equal rights and obligations at the time of marriage, throughout its duration, and at its dissolution. The Church receives this civil framework as the legal context within which it conducts its ministry, while looking to Scripture as the authoritative witness concerning the nature, purpose, and form of marriage as instituted by God. The following Articles set forth the Church's doctrine and practice regarding the recognition and conduct of marriage among its members, in accordance with both the applicable provisions of the Marriage Act and the teaching of Scripture.

### **ARTICLE 5.1 RECOGNITION AND AFFIRMATION OF MONOGAMOUS MARRIAGE.**

The Church affirms that monogamous marriage, lawfully contracted and registered in accordance with Sections 2, 3, and 6 of the Marriage Act No. 4 of 2014, constitutes a complete and scripturally grounded expression of the marital covenant. *For implementation, see Appendix A, Bylaws Clause 10.0. pg17*

*Relevant Scripture: Genesis 2:18-24; Malachi 2:14-15; Matthew 19:4-6; Mark 10:6-9; 1 Corinthians 7:2; Ephesians 5:22-33; 1 Timothy 3:2, 3:12; Titus 1:6*

### **ARTICLE 5.2 RECOGNITION AND AFFIRMATION OF POLYGAMOUS MARRIAGE.**

The Church recognizes polygamous marriage, lawfully contracted and registered under Sections 2, 3, and 6 of the Marriage Act No. 4 of 2014, as carrying equal legal status to monogamous marriage, consistent with *Mary Wanjuhi Muigai v Attorney General* [2015] eKLR. Recognition requires the informed knowledge and consent of all spouses. Members in polygamous households shall receive the same pastoral care, fellowship, and standing as those in monogamous households. *For implementation, see Appendix A, Bylaws Clause 11.0. pg 18 -20*

*Relevant Scripture: Genesis 16:1-4; Genesis 29:15-30; Genesis 30:1-13; Exodus 21:10-11; Deuteronomy 21:15-17; Judges 8:30; 1 Samuel 1:1-2; 2 Samuel 3:2-5; 2 Samuel 5:13; 1 Kings 11:3; 1 Corinthians 7:2; 1 Timothy 3:2, 3:12; Titus 1:6*



### **ARTICLE 5.3 REMARRIAGE**

The Church recognizes marriage as a covenant ordained by God. Remarriage is permitted where one of the following applies: (a) the prior spouse is deceased; (b) a civil divorce has been granted on biblical grounds of sexual immorality; or (c) an unbelieving spouse has permanently abandoned the believing partner. All remarriages conducted under the Church's authority must follow pastoral counselling and receive written approval from the local pastor and the Founding Bishop (or their delegate). *For implementation, see Appendix A, Bylaws Clause 12.0 pg 20 -21*

### **ARTICLE 6: MEMBERSHIP**

*Relevant Scripture: Acts 2:41-47; 1 Corinthians 12:12-13*

Membership is open to all races who believe in Jesus Christ and have been born again (Matthew 28:19-20).

All members shall participate in discipleship programs. Baptism candidates must be ten years of age or above and complete baptismal class.

### **ARTICLE 7: OFFICE BEARERS**

*Relevant Scripture: 1 Timothy 3:1-7; Titus 1:5-9; Acts 20:28 The office*

bearers shall be:

Chairman — His Eminence the Bishop (Vision Bearer).

Secretary — Reverend.

Treasurer — Pastor.

### **ARTICLE 8: FUNCTIONS OF OFFICE BEARERS**

*Relevant Scripture: Hebrews 13:17; 1 Peter 5:1-4*

(Detailed original functions retained: Chairman presides, approves emergencies, flies white flag, appoints/suspends/restores, fills vacancies; Secretary handles correspondence/records; Treasurer manages receipts, disbursements, books — all under Chairman oversight.)

## **ARTICLE 9: MEETINGS**

*Relevant Scripture: Hebrews 10:24-25*

Annual General Meeting (by 31st December), Special General Meetings (called by Chairman or requisition). Notice periods, agendas, quorum, procedure retained.

## **ARTICLE 10: FUNDS AND FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT**

Relevant Scripture: 2 Corinthians 9:6-7; 1 Corinthians 16:1-2

Funds used per objectives. Bank account in Church name. Receipts/deposits by Treasurer with Chairman approval. Cheques signed by any two office bearers (Chairman mandatory). Financial year: 1st January – 31st December.

## **ARTICLE 11: BRANCHES**

Relevant Scripture: Acts 14:23

Branches formed with written approval of the Vision Bearer and Registrar of Societies. All branches adopt this Constitution in full.

## **ARTICLE 12: PARTNERSHIPS AND COOPERATION WITH LOCAL AND INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS**

*Relevant Scripture: Philipians 1:5; Ephesians 4:16; 1 Corinthians 12:12-27*

12.1 The Church may form partnerships/affiliations with local/international churches, NGOs, FBOs, government bodies, educational/health institutions.

12.2 Partnerships must align with Vision/Mission/Doctrine.

12.3 Require prior written approval of Chairman; formalized via MoUs/Agreements.

12.4 May receive grants/donations without compromising independence/doctrine.

## **ARTICLE 13: ESTABLISHMENT OF SCHOOLS AND OTHER FACILITIES**

Relevant Scripture: 2 Timothy 2:2; Proverbs 22:6; Ephesians 4:11-13

13.1 The Church may establish/operate: educational institutions (ECDE to university), theological college, health facilities, orphanages, community centres, etc.

13.2 All in compliance with Kenyan laws, under spiritual/administrative oversight of Chairman.

## **ARTICLE 14: AMENDMENTS TO THE CONSTITUTION**

*Relevant Scripture: Acts 15:1-29*

Amendments approved by Chairman at General Meeting; require prior written consent of Registrar of Societies, signed by three office bearers.

## **ARTICLE 15: INSPECTION OF ACCOUNTS AND MEMBERS REGISTER**

*Relevant Scripture: 1 Corinthians 4:2*

Chairman appoints two executive members for inspection at any time.

## **ARTICLE 16: AUDITOR**

Relevant Scripture: Proverbs 27:23

Qualified auditor appointed annually by Executive Committee (Chairman approval). Audits accounts annually; report to Chairman/AGM.

## **ARTICLE 17: DISSOLUTION**

Relevant Scripture: Matthew 6:19-21; Acts 4:32-35

Dissolution by two-thirds vote at Special General Meeting called for purpose. Requires Registrar consent (signed by three office bearers). Remaining assets transferred to similar religious/charitable society as directed by Chairman/meeting.

## **ARTICLE 18: DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE**

Relevant Scripture: Matthew 18:15-17; Galatians 6:1; 2 Corinthians 2:6-11; 1 Corinthians 5:6-7; Hebrews 12:11; James 2:1-9

18.1 Purpose: Restore the individual, protect church purity/unity/witness, promote repentance and holiness.

18.2 Applicability: All members/leaders for unrepentant sin, doctrinal error, financial misconduct, immorality, conduct damaging church witness/unity, persistent violation of Constitution/Core Values.

18.3 Disciplinary Committee: 5 members appointed by Chairman (senior pastors/elders/mature members); excludes accused/related parties. For Chairman allegations: Committee excludes Chairman; may include external mediators.

18.4 Progressive Steps:

- a. Private confrontation
  - b. With 1–2 witnesses
  - c. Referred to Disciplinary Committee (investigate, hear accused, recommend)
  - d. Recommendation to Executive/General Meeting for suspension, removal, exclusion
- 18.5 Restoration: Genuine repentance leads to forgiveness, comfort, full restoration.
- 18.6 Appeal: Written to Chairman within 14 days; Chairman reviews or appoints panel (final).
- 18.7 Principles: Prayerful, confidential (except public sin), just, impartial, transparent; complies with natural justice/Kenyan law.

#### **ARTICLE 19: CODE OF CONDUCT FOR LEADERS**

***Relevant Scripture: 1 Timothy 3:1-7; Titus 1:5-9; 1 Peter 5:1-4; 2 Corinthians 6:3; Philippians 2:5***

- 19.1 Purpose: Leaders model Christ-like character, uphold holiness, integrity, accountability.
- 19.2 General Standards: Above reproach, faithful in marriage/family, self-controlled, sound doctrine, hospitable, gentle, not quarrelsome, not lover of money.
- 19.3 Financial Integrity: Transparent handling of funds, no misuse, disclose conflicts, tithe faithfully.
- 19.4 Relational/Moral Conduct: Avoid immorality/abuse/exploitation, maintain boundaries, speak truth in love, avoid gossip/slander, promote unity.
- 19.5 Public Ministry/Witness: Avoid discrediting actions, use social media responsibly, fly white flag in official functions.
- 19.6 Accountability: Submit to Vision Bearer/Executive, regular reviews, report breaches.
- 19.7 Consequences: Breaches follow Article 18 Disciplinary Procedure.

## **ARTICLE 20: COMPLIANCE WITH NATIONAL LAWS**

Relevant Scripture: Romans 13:1-7

- 20.1 The Church shall at all times operate in full compliance with the Constitution of the Republic of Kenya 2010 (supreme law) and all applicable laws, statutes, regulations, directives, and policies of the Government of Kenya.
- 20.2 This includes (but is not limited to) the Societies Act (Cap 108), Charities Act, Education Act, Data Protection Act 2019, employment laws, financial reporting requirements, and all relevant subsidiary legislation.
- 20.3 All activities, branches, schools, facilities, partnerships, and financial dealings shall strictly adhere to national legal requirements.
- 20.4 In case of conflict between this Constitution and Kenyan law, Kenyan law shall prevail, provided such compliance does not require compromise of core biblical doctrines in Article 4.

**Adopted this 5th day of November 2025 (Revised Edition)**

**Signed:**

|                                               |       |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------|
| <b>His Eminence The Bishop (Chairman)</b>     | ..... |
| <b>Rev. Vivian Anyango Obonyo (Secretary)</b> | ..... |
| <b>Pst. Odera Geoff Heaviside (Treasurer)</b> | ..... |

## **APPENDIX A: SAMPLE BYLAWS**

### **Bylaws**

(Operational Rules – Subject to the Constitution)

Adopted: 5th November 2025

(To be reviewed/amended annually or as needed by the Executive Committee)

### **1. PURPOSE OF BYLAWS**

These Bylaws provide detailed procedures for the day-to-day administration and ministry operations of LSDCI in accordance with the Constitution, the Word of God, and the laws of the Republic of Kenya.

### **2. MEMBERSHIP PROCEDURES**

#### **2.1 Admission to Membership**

Prospective members must confess faith in Jesus Christ as Lord and Saviour, complete a baptismal/discipleship class (minimum 6–12 weeks), and be baptized by immersion (if not previously baptized scripturally).

Applicants aged 10+ shall be received after interview by a pastor/elder.

New members shall sign a membership commitment form affirming agreement with the Statement of Faith, Core Values, and submission to church leadership.

#### **2.2 Membership Register**

The Secretary shall maintain an up-to-date digital and physical register of members (name, date of joining, baptism date, contact details, branch).

Annual verification shall occur during the Annual General Meeting preparations.

#### **2.3 Transfer of Membership**

Members transferring to another branch or affiliated church shall receive a letter of commendation from the pastor.

### **3. MEETINGS – DETAILED PROCEDURES**

#### **3.1 Quorum**

Annual General Meeting: At least 30% of registered members or 50 members (whichever is less).

Executive Committee: Majority (50% + 1) of appointed members.

Special General Meeting: Same as AGM unless otherwise specified.

#### **3.2 Voting**

Decisions shall normally be by simple majority of members present and voting, except where the Constitution specifies otherwise (e.g., dissolution – 2/3).

The Chairman (His Eminence the Bishop) has a casting vote in case of a tie.

#### **3.3 Minutes**

The Secretary shall record minutes of all meetings, which shall be read and confirmed at the next meeting.

Minutes shall be signed by the Chairman and Secretary.

### **4.0 MINISTRY DEPARTMENTS & COMMITTEES**

4.1 The Church may establish the following standing departments/committees (subject to Chairman approval):

Worship & Music

Evangelism & Outreach

Discipleship & Bible Study

Youth & Children

Women's Ministry

Men's Fellowship

Media & Communications

Finance & Stewardship

Education & Theological Training

Community Development & Mercy Ministry

- 4.2 Each department shall have a Coordinator appointed by the Chairman or Executive Committee. Coordinators report to the Executive Committee.
- 4.3 Ad-hoc committees (e.g., Building Committee, Crusade Planning) may be formed as needed.

## **5. 0 ORDINATION, LICENSING & APPOINTMENT OF MINISTERS**

### **5.1 Ordination/Licensing**

Candidates must complete theological training (*most preferable from International Leadership University, ILU*) with a minimum entry qualification of a certificate demonstrate character & calling, and be recommended by their pastor. Ordination service shall be conducted by the Eminence the Bishop. (Chairman) Licensed ministers serve under supervision; ordained ministers may lead branches.

### **5.2 Renumeration**

Pastors shall receive a monthly stipend from the church as outlined and stipulated by the Church's Financial Policy.

### **5.3 Removal**

Follows Article 18 (Disciplinary Procedure) and Article 19 (Code of Conduct).

## **6. FINANCIAL PROCEDURES**

### **6.1 Budget**

Annual budget prepared by Treasurer, reviewed by Finance Committee, approved by Executive Committee before AGM.

### **6.2 Offerings & Tithes**

All offerings counted by at least two persons; receipted where possible.

Tithes & offerings banked within 48 hours.

### **6.3 Expenditure Limits**

Expenditures over KSh 50,000 require Chairman's written approval.

Emergency expenditures up to KSh 100,000 may be approved by Chairman alone and reported at next Executive meeting.



## 6.4 Annual Financial Report

Presented at AGM with Auditor's report.

## 7. PROPERTY & ASSETS

- 7.1 All property acquired by the Church is held in the name of **LIFE SPRING DOMINION CHURCH INTERNATIONAL** (registered society).
- 7.2 No property shall be sold, mortgaged, or disposed of without approval of a General Meeting and written consent of the Founding Bishop (as required by law).
- 7.3 All real and movable property held by or on behalf of any local assembly shall be registered in the name of, and held as an asset of, Life Spring Dominion Church International.
- 7.4 Where a local assembly disaffiliates, is dissolved, or ceases to operate, all property registered under **clause 7.3** shall remain the property of Life Spring Dominion Church International, and no individual member, leader, or local assembly shall hold any claim, interest, or right of distribution in respect of such property.

## 8. AMENDMENT OF BYLAWS

- 8.1 Bylaws may be amended by a simple majority vote of the Executive Committee, subject to ratification at the next General Meeting.
- 8.2 Amendments must not contradict the Constitution or Kenyan law.

## 9. CONFLICT RESOLUTION

- 9.1 Minor disputes resolved through Matthew 18:15–17 process.
- 9.2 Serious matters referred to Disciplinary Committee (Article 18).

## 10.0: RECOGNITION AND IMPLEMENTATION OF MONOGAMOUS MARRIAGE

- 10.1 **Definition.** For purposes of this clause, "monogamous marriage" shall carry the meaning given to it under Section 6(2) of the Marriage Act No. 4 of 2014, namely a marriage celebrated in Christian or civil form, and registered accordingly with the Registrar of Marriages.
- 10.2 **Proof of Marital Status.** Members presenting themselves for marriage-related ministry, including but not limited to wedding solemnization, marriage counselling, and enrollment in marriage-related Church programs, shall provide a copy of their marriage certificate or such other documentation as the Church may reasonably require to confirm registration under the Marriage Act.

**10.3 Pastoral Ministry.** The Church's marriage counselling, pre-marital and post-marital programs, and family ministry curricula shall be developed and administered on the premise of monogamous union, consistent with Article 5 of the Statement of Faith.

**10.4 Officiating Clergy.** Ministers of the Church authorized to solemnize marriages shall do so only in accordance with the monogamous form recognized under Section 6(2) of the Marriage Act, and shall ensure that all documentation required under Sections 53 and 54 of the Act is properly completed and transmitted to the Registrar.

**10.5 Review.** This clause shall be reviewed by the Church's governing body not less than once every five years, or sooner if amendments to the Marriage Act necessitate reconsideration.

## **11.0 RECOGNITION AND AFFIRMATION OF POLYGAMOUS MARRIAGE.**

### **11.1 Purpose**

by setting out clear, pastoral, legal and administrative procedures for recognition, pastoral care, leadership eligibility, dispute resolution and recordkeeping for polygamous households within Life Spring Dominion Church International.

### **11.2 Scope**

This bylaw applies to **all members, leaders, branches and ministries** of the Church and governs:

- recognition of polygamous unions for membership and sacramental participation;
- pastoral care and counselling for polygamous households;
- eligibility of spouses for leadership and ministry roles;
- documentation, registration and recordkeeping; and
- dispute resolution and child welfare safeguards.

### **Key provisions**

#### **11.3 Recognition and Registration**

- The Church shall **recognize** polygamous marriages that are **lawfully contracted and registered** under Kenyan law.
- Recognition for Church purposes requires presentation of **civil marriage certificates** or other lawful proof of registration for each spouse.
- Where a union is customary but not yet civilly registered, the Church may provide pastoral support while encouraging lawful registration; full ecclesial recognition follows civil registration.

#### 11.4. Pastoral Care and Counselling

- Polygamous households shall receive the **same pastoral care, counselling, fellowship and standing** as monogamous households.
- Pastoral teams will offer **pre-marital, pre-additional-spouse and ongoing family counselling**, addressing roles, consent, finances, children's welfare and conflict prevention.
- Any new spouse joining an existing union must undergo a **pastoral orientation** and sign a Church acknowledgement of rights and responsibilities.

#### 11.5 Consent and Informed Agreement

- The Church requires **informed consent of all existing spouses** before recognizing or blessing the addition of another spouse.
- The local pastor shall obtain written confirmation that all parties understand legal, financial and family implications.

#### 11.6 Leadership and Ministry Eligibility

- Spouses in polygamous unions may serve in **non-leadership roles** without restriction.
- **Eligibility for ordained or senior leadership** (as defined in Article 7 and Article 19) requires that the candidate meet the moral and doctrinal qualifications in Article 19 and disclose marital status.
- Where Scripture or Article 19 sets specific marital expectations for certain offices, the Executive Committee will apply those standards consistently, with pastoral sensitivity and case-by-case review.

#### 11.7 Ceremonies and Public Ministry

- The Church may **officiate or bless** polygamous unions only where civil registration and informed consent are verified and where the ceremony complies with Kenyan law.
- Public ministry by members of polygamous households shall be governed by the same standards of conduct and accountability as other members.

#### 11.8 Children and Welfare Safeguards

- The Church prioritizes the **welfare of children** in polygamous households. Pastoral care must include child protection measures, schooling support and mediation where necessary.
- Any allegation of abuse or neglect will be handled under Article 18 (Disciplinary Procedure) and reported to civil authorities as required by law.

### 11.9 Documentation and Recordkeeping

- The Secretary shall record marital status and civil registration details in the **Membership Register** (Bylaws 2.2).
- Copies of civil marriage certificates and any written consents shall be retained confidentially in the church records.

### 11.11 Training and Capacity Building

- The Church will provide **regular training** for pastors and counsellors on polygamy-related pastoral care, Kenyan family law, child protection and conflict mediation.

## 12.0 REMARRIAGE

### 12.1 Purpose

To provide a clear, compassionate, and biblically grounded process for considering and approving remarriage within Life Spring Dominion Church International.

### 12.2 Eligibility

- **Widow/Widower:** Free to remarry; should marry *in the Lord*. (1 Corinthians 7:39)
- **Divorce for sexual immorality:** Eligible for remarriage after pastoral review and presentation of civil divorce documents. (Matthew 19:9)
- **Abandonment by unbelieving spouse:** Eligible after verification of permanent abandonment. (1 Corinthians 7:15)
- **Other divorces:** Require a period of pastoral counselling, evidence of repentance or reconciliation attempts, and panel review before approval. (1 Corinthians 7:10–11)

### 12.3 Required steps before Church officiation

1. **Application:** The member submits a written Remarriage Application to the local pastor, attaching civil documentation (death certificate or divorce decree).
2. **Counselling:** The applicant completes a minimum of three pastoral counselling sessions addressing biblical teaching on marriage, reconciliation attempts, children's welfare, and readiness for a new covenant.
3. **Documentation:** Provide certified civil documents: death certificate, final divorce decree, or evidence of abandonment/separation as applicable.
4. **Marriage Review Panel:** The local pastor convenes a three-person Marriage Review Panel (pastor + two mature leaders) to review the case, interview the applicant(s), and prepare a written recommendation.

5. **Final approval:** The Chairman (or designated delegate) issues written approval before the Church officiates the remarriage. No Church officiation occurs without this written approval.
6. **Record keeping:** All applications, panel minutes, counselling notes (summary), and approvals are filed in the Membership Register and retained per Bylaws 2.2.

#### 12.4 Pastoral safeguards and leader standards

- Leaders must disclose prior marital history when seeking appointment and meet the qualifications in Article 19. (*1 Timothy 3:2; Titus 1:6*)
- The Church will provide ongoing discipleship and family support to remarried couples.
- Any exception to this procedure requires written justification and Chairman approval.

#### 12.5 Confidentiality and pastoral care

- The process shall be conducted prayerfully and confidentially, balancing pastoral care with the need for transparency in cases affecting children or public trust.
- The Church will seek reconciliation where possible and will prioritize the welfare of children and vulnerable parties.

#### 12.6 Appeals

- If an applicant is denied approval, they may appeal in writing to the Chairman within 14 days. The Chairman may review the panel's recommendation or appoint an appeals panel whose decision is final.

**Scriptural references for Section 11:** *Matthew 19:3–9; Mark 10:11–12; 1 Corinthians 7:10–16; 1 Corinthians 7:39; 1 Timothy 3:2; Titus 1:6.*

11. EFFECTIVE DATE

These Bylaws take effect immediately upon adoption by the Executive Committee and ratification at the first General Meeting following the adoption of the Constitution.

Approved by Executive Committee:

His Eminence The Bishop (Chairman) .....

Rev. Vivian Anayango Obonyo (Secretary) .....

Pst. Odera Geoff Heaviside (Treasurer) .....

Date:.....

LIFE SPRING DOMINION CHURCH INTERNATIONAL